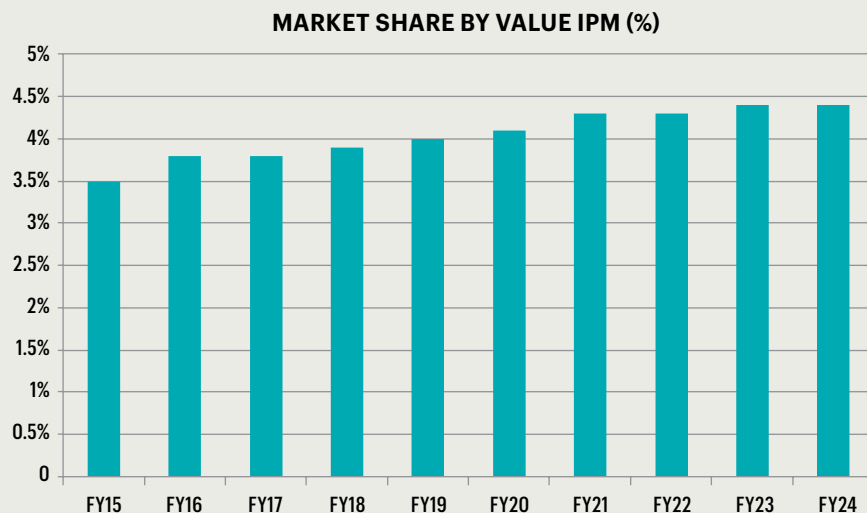


CHARTING GROWTH

• Mankind has outperformed the Indian Pharmaceutical Market (IPM) with in-house manufacturing and R&D capabilities

SOURCE ANNUAL REPORT 2024



in these underserved regions.”

One of the biggest challenges the company faced was scepticism about the quality of its lower-priced medicines.

“To address this, we provided free samples to doctors, allowing them to test our products. We also conducted independent third-party lab testing and shared reports with doctors, proving that our medicines met the required standards,” says Juneja.

As the company expanded, it realised that by 2004, its portfolio was primarily focused on acute care—antibiotics and painkillers. Meanwhile, the industry was shifting towards chronic diseases such as diabetes, hypertension, and cardiovascular conditions. The rise in lifestyle-related diseases was driving demand for long-term medication, and competitors were already establishing their presence in this space. Recognising this shift, Mankind Pharma made a strategic decision to enter the chronic disease segment.

Despite its expansion, Mankind Pharma remained committed to acute care. A turning point came in 2007 with the launch of its consumer healthcare division.

“Before this, the general public wasn’t widely aware of Mankind Pharma,” says Arjun Juneja. “But our consumer business changed that. Today, it contributes about 10% of our revenue, with brands like Manforce, Prega News, and Gas-O-Fast leading their categories.”

RIISING THROUGH RESEARCH

For a long time, Mankind Pharma was perceived as a marketing-driven company rather than a research-fo-

cused one. The company sought to change this narrative by investing in research and development. The launch of dydrogesterone marked a turning point.

“A big breakthrough for us was dydrogesterone,” Juneja explains. In 2019, Mankind Pharma launched dydrogesterone under the brand name Dydroboon, becoming the only company besides Abbott to offer this molecule.”

The company has also been actively working on new drug discovery, particularly in the obesity treatment segment. The acquisition of Bharat Serums provided Mankind Pharma an entry into the high-barrier super-specialty segment, particularly IVF treatments. The acquisition also strengthened its biologics portfolio.

Looking ahead, the company is set to launch 70-80 new products this year, including Empagliflozin, which was launched in mid March.

While Mankind Pharma has expanded internationally, its primary focus remains India. “Our priority is still Bharat,” Juneja emphasises.

Tushar Manudhane, Research Analyst at Motilal Oswal Financial Services Ltd, notes that Mankind Pharma’s differentiated portfolio—comprising prescription products (including the recently acquired BSV), consumer wellness, and exports—positions the company for strong growth over the next four to five years.

New acquisitions, R&D of new drugs, and a focus on OTC segment and affordability has cemented Mankind Pharma’s position and with Ramesh Juneja at the helm, it seems like it is a smooth ride to the top. **BT**

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